



Rose Pruning Made Easy

Rachel Maggiore | Seed Sensations Gardening Services



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Why Do We Prune?

More Flowers

Pruning encourages vigorous new growth that produces the best blooms

Healthier Plants

Removes dead, diseased and crossing branches to improve airflow

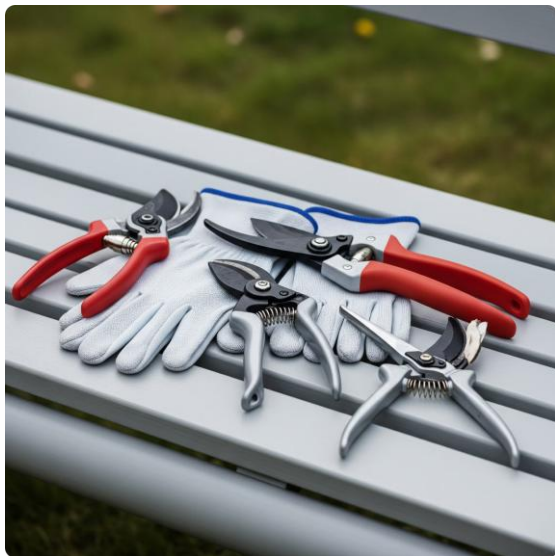
Better Shape

Keeps roses tidy, manageable and looking their best

✔ Even a rough prune is better than no prune at all — roses are incredibly resilient!



Tools You'll Need



- **Bypass secateurs** — your most-used tool; gives the cleanest cut
- **Loppers** — for thicker canes you can't reach with secateurs
- **Pruning saw** — for very old, woody stems
- **Gloves** — thick leather to protect from thorns
- **Safety glasses** — beware of thorns!

 Spray and wipe blades with **methylated spirits** between plants to prevent spreading disease.

Blunt blades crush the stem and let disease in. Keep them sharp.

TIP: Ratchet-style secateurs are excellent for those with arthritis or a weaker grip.

When to Prune

Winter — June/July

Main prune while roses are dormant and leafless.
Aim for the Winter solstice as a handy reminder
(June 21).

Summer — Deadheading

Snip spent blooms back to the first set of five
leaves to encourage repeat flowering.

1

2

3

4

Frosty Areas (including zones in Melbourne)

Wait until after the final frost before pruning —
new growth can be burnt off by a late frost. Mid-
late August

Autumn — Light Tidy

Remove dead or diseased branches before winter
sets in.



The Golden Rules — For Every Rose

Remove the 3 Ds first

Dead, Damaged and Diseased wood — always the first thing to go, regardless of variety.

Cut to an outward-facing bud

New growth follows the bud direction — outward buds create an open, vase-like shape.

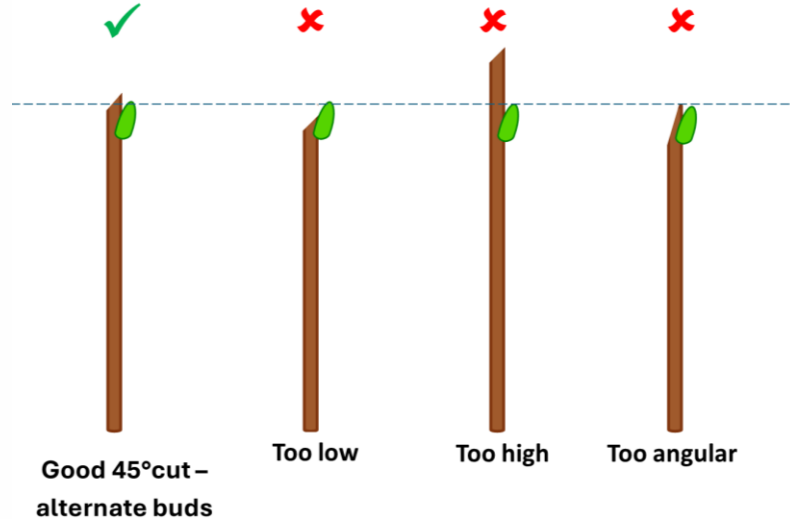
Remove crossing or rubbing branches

Friction damages stems and invites disease — keep the centre open and airy.

How to Make the Perfect Cut

Here's what to aim for:

Correct Cut
45° angle, 5mm
above outward
bud, slopes away



Too Low
Cuts the bud and
prevents new
growth

Too High
Stub left above
bud, dies back
and invites
disease

Too angular
Too much exposed surface
takes longer to heal and
invites disease or dieback

Rose Varieties & How to Prune Them



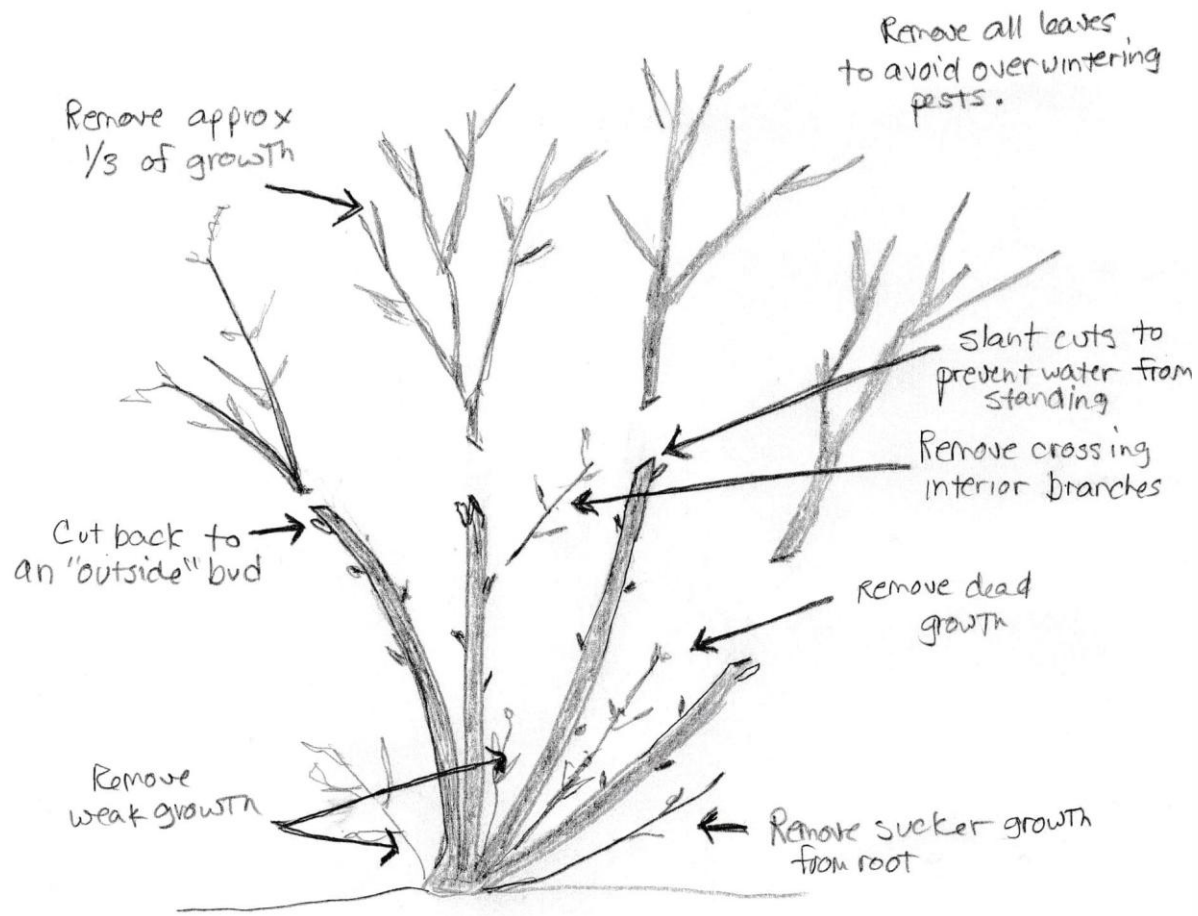
Hybrid Tea

Work bottom-up. Count **10 nodes from the base** and cut. Remove all old dark-barked wood entirely at the base — the hardest prune of all rose types.



Floribunda

Work top-down. **Reduce by one-third** in every direction. Remove dead wood and crossing branches.





https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_UWFYU40z2E



David Austin / English

Cut back by **one-third to one-half**.
Remove older, woody canes at the
base to rejuvenate the shrub.



Banksia rose

Rambling Roses

Prune after flowering in summer —
not in winter! Remove one or two old
canes at the base each year to
renew.

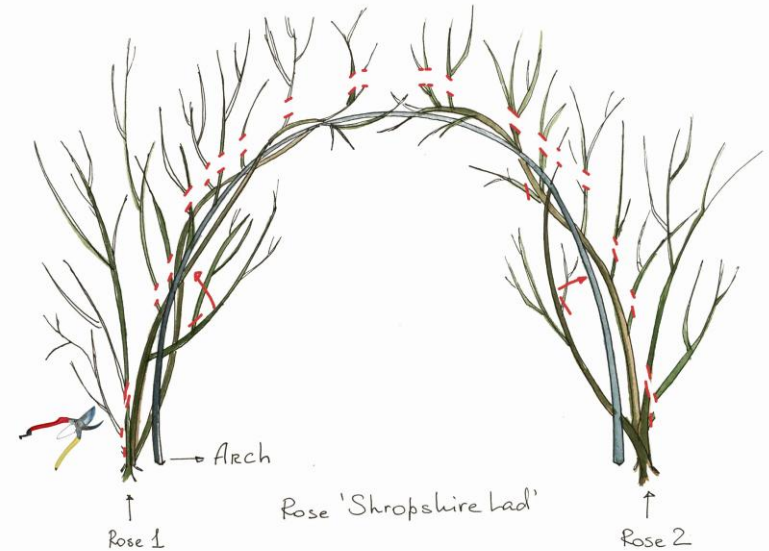
⚠ Common mistake: Rambling roses flower on old wood —
pruning them in winter removes next season's blooms!



Cecile brunner

Climbing Roses

Keep the long main canes. Cut **side shoots back to ~10cm** from the main stem. Remove spindly or crossing wood only.



Standard & Standard Weeping



Treat the same as hybrid or floribunda and prune to outward facing buds, even with weeping roses. A standard is pruned in the same way as a hybrid or floribunda but less severely. Approx 8 buds from the graft.

More Rose Varieties at a Glance



Carpet / Groundcover

Reduce by **two-thirds** in winter. Clear the centre for airflow to prevent black spot.

Rugosa / Species

Very tough. Can be **roughly hedged with shears**, removing one-third to one-half. Incredibly thorny!

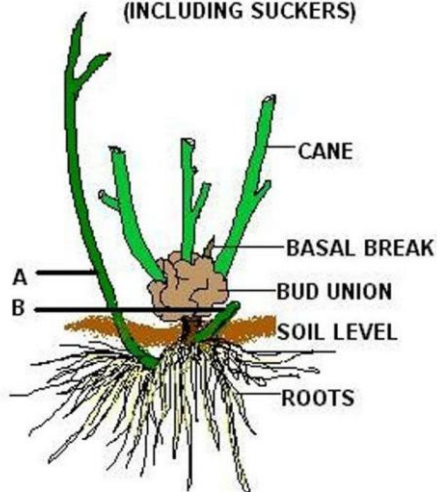


Miniature & Patio

Treat like floribundas on a **smaller scale**. Use fine scissors or small secateurs. Perfect for pots.

What About Suckers?

THE PARTS OF A GRAFTED ROSE
(INCLUDING SUCKERS)



A = Sucker from the roots
B = Sucker from rootstock, below grafts

What is a sucker?

Suckers are shoots that grow from **below the graft union** — the knobby join near the base of the plant. They come from the rootstock, not the desirable variety.

How to identify them

- Smaller leaves with **7 leaflets** instead of the usual 5
- Often a different colour — more reddish or bright green stems
- More thorns than the rest of the plant

What to do



Trace the sucker back to the root and **pull it off** at the source.



Watch: Rose Pruning in Action - Summary



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0lqoGHG27b8>



Demonstration

Any volunteers?

After Pruning — Don't Forget!

Clean Up

Rake and remove all pruned material. **Do not compost diseased leaves** — they go in the bin, or you recycle the disease back into the garden.

Feed

Apply a good **rose fertiliser** straight after pruning to fuel the burst of new growth. Suggested: Sudden Impact for roses by Neutrog. Anything with a higher Phosphorous ratio for flowering (not around natives).

Mulch

A 5cm layer of mulch around the base retains moisture and suppresses weeds. The State rose garden uses Neutrog's Who Flung Dung.

Water

Give a **good deep drink** after pruning, especially in dry conditions, to help the plant recover quickly.



Your Pruning Cheat Sheet 🌹

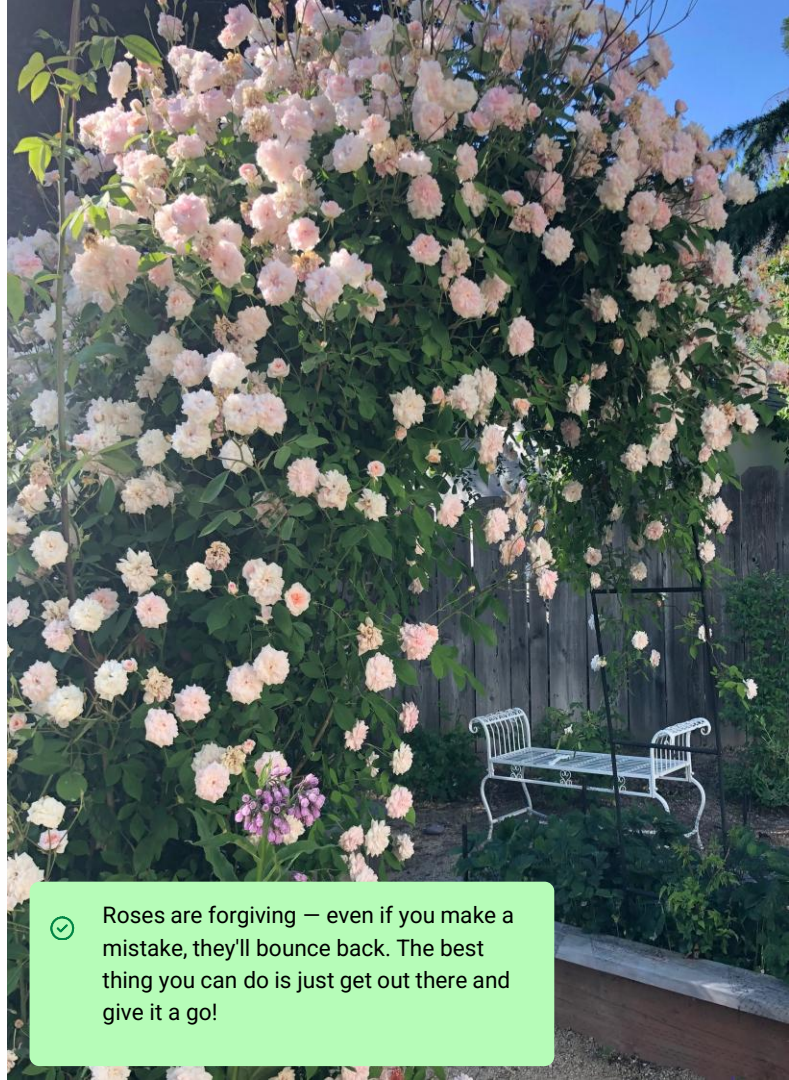
Photograph this slide to keep as a handy reminder at home!

The Essentials

- ✓ Prune in **winter** when dormant
- ✓ Always use **clean, sharp tools**
- ✓ Cut at **45°**, just above an **outward-facing bud**
- ✓ Remove the **3 Ds** — Dead, Diseased, Damaged

And Remember

- ✓ Open the **centre** for good airflow
- ✓ **Pull** suckers — never cut them
- ✓ Feed, mulch and water **after pruning**
- 🌸 **Don't be afraid to prune hard** — roses are tough and will reward you!



Roses are forgiving — even if you make a mistake, they'll bounce back. The best thing you can do is just get out there and give it a go!

THANK YOU !



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Sources

- [Everything you need to know to start pruning | Gardening Australia](#)
- [Principles of Pruning — Gardening Australia](#)
- [Rose Pruning: General Tips | RHS Advice](#)
- [Winter Pruning — Gardening Australia](#)
- [Victoria State Rose garden](#)
- [London Blooms](#)
- [Gardening with Johnny A – How to prune old roses](#)